

Five candlestick lessons, tested on our own market

What the videos teach, where they agree, and what each rule actually earned on 399 NSE stocks over 45 sessions (13 Jul to 11 Sep 2026), plus what it would have done to the engines' own trades.

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1. The answer first

Raw candle shapes on 5-minute bars are noise. Across 1,231,827 pattern trades, gross expectancy sits within a few basis points of zero and net expectancy is about the cost of trading. Hit rates are 28 to 36% against a 2-to-1 target that needs 33%. No lesson's single-candle or two-candle shape pays for itself when taken everywhere it appears.

Nothing intraday beat its costs; a few daily patterns did. The filters every lesson insists on (a run before the pattern, a key level under it, the first 90 minutes) move expectancy a few basis points in the right direction but never past break-even on 5- or 15-minute bars. On daily bars, three patterns were net positive with at least 100 trades over one year. The table below ranks every pattern-and-setting pair with at least 100 trades.

Best pattern-and-setting pairs (n ≥ 100)

pattern	setting	n	win	avg R	net bps
3-bar reversal bull (L2)	Daily	329	40%	+0.09	+73.5
Pin bar bull (L2)	Daily	127	43%	+0.08	+61.4
Engulfing bear (L2/L3)	Daily	387	42%	+0.12	+10.2
Bull flag (L1)	Daily	140	32%	-0.08	+0.4
Bear flag (L1)	Daily	167	40%	+0.10	-1.0
Doji at top (L1)	Daily	494	38%	+0.04	-1.5
3-bar continuation bull (L2)	5-min, key level + first 90	592	37%	+0.06	-3.6
Hammer (L1/L2/L3)	Daily	1143	34%	-0.07	-3.6

4 of 123 pattern-and-setting pairs are net positive, all on daily bars. "bps" is basis points of price per trade after 12 bps round-trip costs; 10 bps on a ₹1,00,000 position is ₹100.

Worst

pattern	setting	n	win	avg R	net bps
Doji at bottom (L1)	Daily	875	31%	-0.14	-26.0
Shrinking bull (L2)	Daily	734	32%	-0.11	-31.0
3-bar continuation bear (L2)	Daily	267	35%	-0.10	-34.4
3-bar continuation bull (L2)	Daily	237	32%	-0.21	-61.5
3-bar reversal bear (L2)	Daily	173	36%	-0.05	-62.0

2. What the lessons teach

- **Lesson 1: How to Read Candlestick Patterns (Warrior Trading, 54:55)** (01-warrior-read-candlestick-patterns.md)
- **Lesson 2: The BEST Candlestick Pattern Guide (22:59)** (02-top-six-patterns-guide.md)
- **Lesson 3: The "ONE CANDLE" Scalping Strategy / Quick Flip Scalper (23:27)** (03-quick-flip-opening-range-reversal.md)
- **Lesson 4: "Trading Like an Idiot" / The Sneaky Pivot (26:13)** (04-sneaky-pivot-range-lines.md)
- **Lesson 5: "This 9:15 AM Options Strategy Works Everyday" ft. Rajesh Jain (1:14:13)** (05-rajesh-jain-915-open-price-rule.md)
- **What the five lessons agree on, where they differ, and what is testable** (06-comparison.md)

The common core

All five teachers, in different words, say the same four things. A wick is the message: a long lower wick means buyers absorbed a dip, a long upper wick means sellers rejected a high. A reversal candle is a signal, not an entry; the next candle must confirm by breaking the reversal candle's extreme. Location beats shape: the same candle means nothing inside a range and everything at a level or the end of a run. The stop goes behind the structure, and the target is about twice the risk or the far side of the structure.

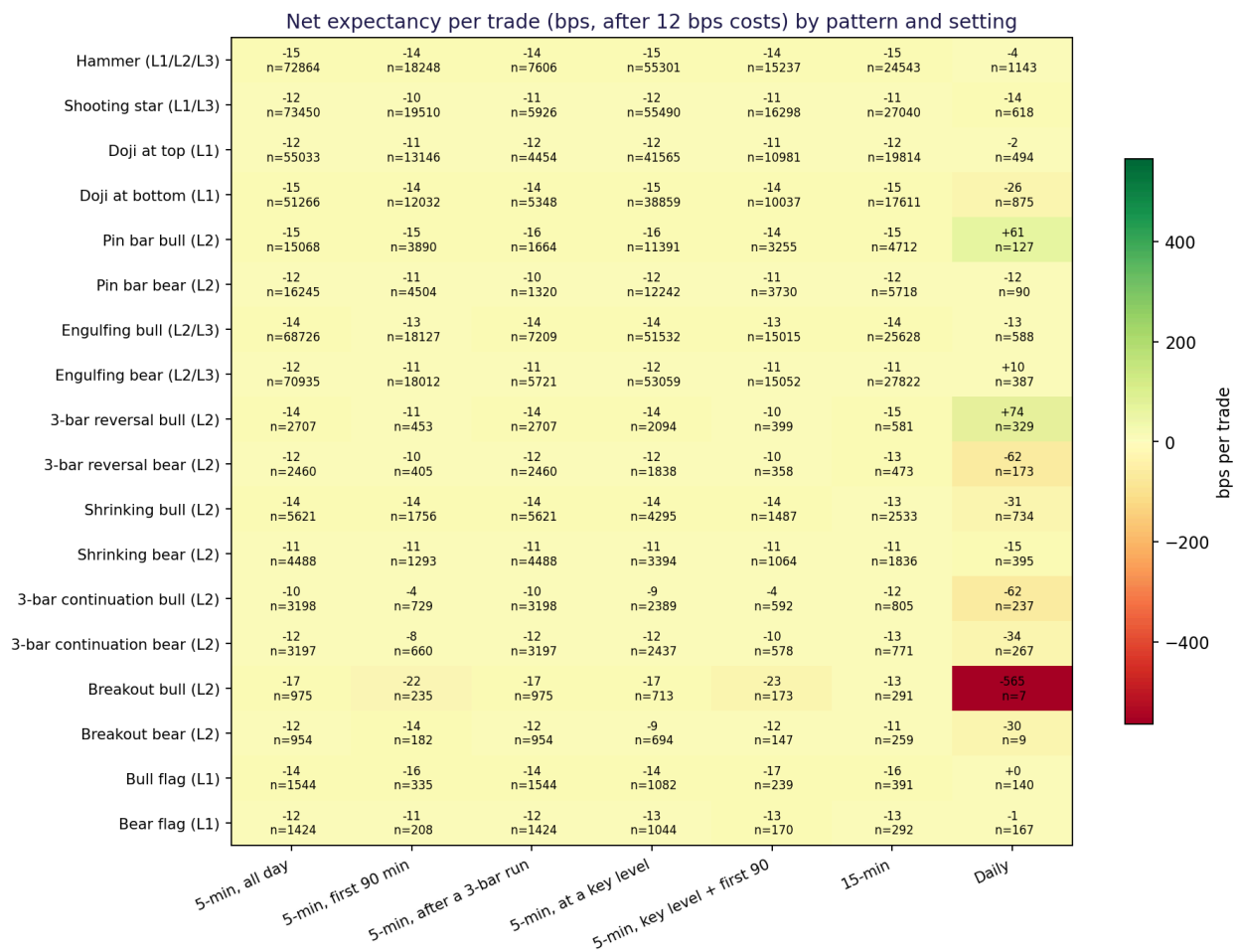
Where they disagree

Is the opening move a trap or the truth? Lesson 3 and lesson 4 say the first 15-minute candle is engineered liquidity that gets reversed; trade against it once a reversal candle prints outside the range. Lesson 5 says the first minute's direction holds for 15 minutes; trade with it and leave at 09:30. **Timeframe:** lesson 1 works on 1- and 5-minute bars, lesson 2 says patterns are unreliable below one hour. **Vocabulary:** lesson 1 names ten candles, lesson 3 keeps two. These disagreements are exactly what the backtest settles.

How the test was run

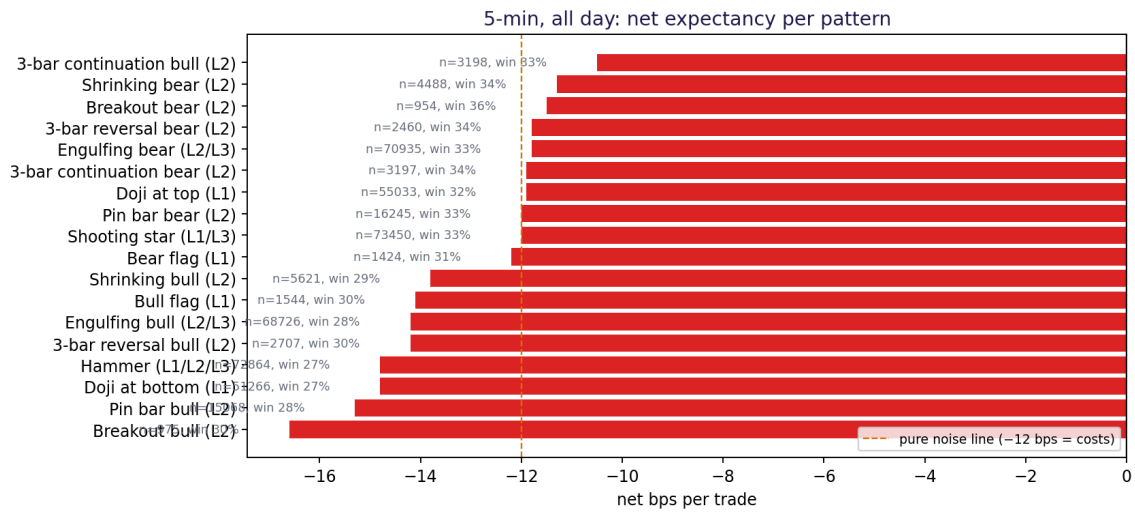
Every rule was written as a detector on open, high, low, close. Entry is the next bar's open after the signal completes, so there is no look-ahead. The stop is the level the lesson prescribes for that pattern. The target is twice the risk. Anything still open is closed at the session end. If a bar touches both the stop and the target, it counts as a stop. Costs are 12 basis points round trip, the same model the fleet uses. Every trade risks a fixed ₹500 so rupee totals compare across patterns. Data: 399 stocks from the engines' universe, 5-minute bars from 13 July to 11 September 2026, 15-minute bars built from them, and one year of daily bars.

3. Every pattern, every setting



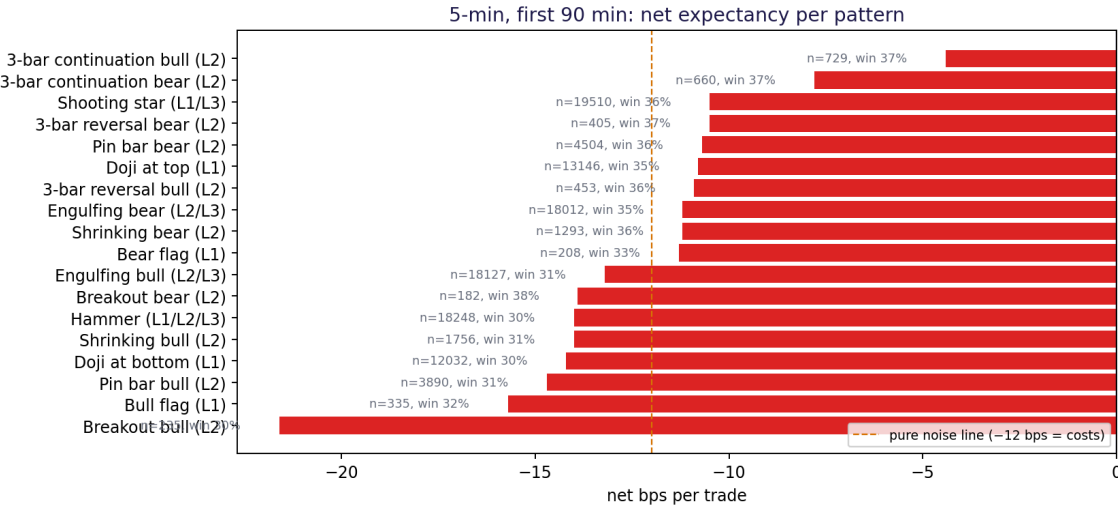
Each cell is the net expectancy per trade for that pattern in that setting, with the trade count. Green earns, red loses. A cell near -12 is pure noise: the pattern added nothing and costs took their 12 bps.

5-min, all day



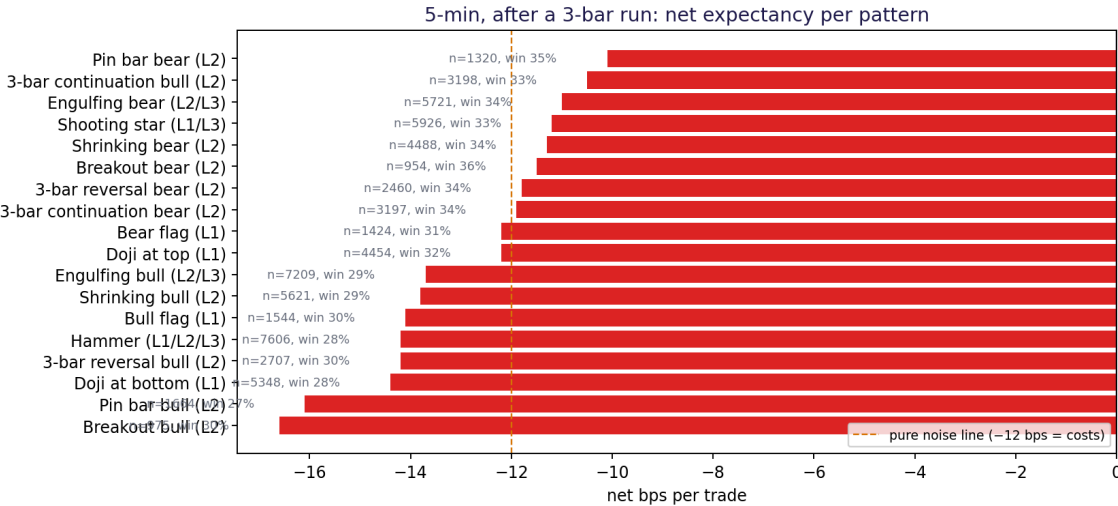
pattern	n	per_day	win%	gross_bps	net_bps	avg_R	target%	stop%
3-bar continuation bull (L2)	3198	71.1	33.0	1.5	-10.5	-0.04	26.0	61.0
Shrinking bear (L2)	4488	99.7	34.0	0.7	-11.3	0.05	32.0	61.0
Breakout bear (L2)	954	21.2	36.0	0.5	-11.5	0.04	28.0	58.0
3-bar reversal bear (L2)	2460	54.7	34.0	0.2	-11.8	0.01	25.0	56.0
Engulfing bear (L2/L3)	70935	1576.3	33.0	0.2	-11.8	0.02	32.0	63.0
3-bar continuation bear (L2)	3197	71.0	34.0	0.1	-11.9	0.01	28.0	60.0
Doji at top (L1)	55033	1223.0	32.0	0.1	-11.9	0.0	31.0	64.0
Pin bar bear (L2)	16245	361.0	33.0	0.0	-12.0	-0.0	29.0	62.0
Shooting star (L1/L3)	73450	1632.2	33.0	0.0	-12.0	0.0	30.0	63.0
Bear flag (L1)	1424	31.6	31.0	-0.2	-12.2	-0.05	29.0	65.0
Shrinking bull (L2)	5621	124.9	29.0	-1.8	-13.8	-0.11	28.0	68.0
Bull flag (L1)	1544	34.3	30.0	-2.1	-14.1	-0.09	28.0	66.0
Engulfing bull (L2/L3)	68726	1527.2	28.0	-2.2	-14.2	-0.13	27.0	68.0
3-bar reversal bull (L2)	2707	60.2	30.0	-2.2	-14.2	-0.11	24.0	62.0
Hammer (L1/L2/L3)	72864	1619.2	27.0	-2.8	-14.8	-0.16	26.0	69.0
Doji at bottom (L1)	51266	1139.2	27.0	-2.8	-14.8	-0.15	26.0	69.0
Pin bar bull (L2)	15068	334.8	28.0	-3.3	-15.3	-0.16	25.0	68.0
Breakout bull (L2)	975	21.7	30.0	-4.6	-16.6	-0.13	25.0	65.0

5-min, first 90 min



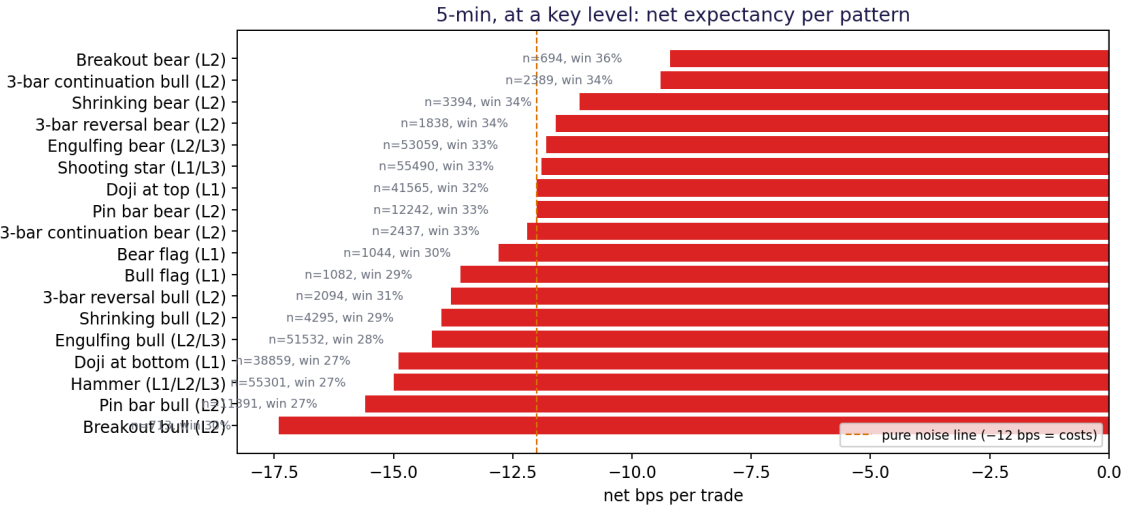
pattern	n	per_day	win%	gross_bps	net_bps	avg_R	target%	stop%
3-bar continuation bull (L2)	729	16.2	37.0	7.6	-4.4	0.08	31.0	59.0
3-bar continuation bear (L2)	660	14.7	37.0	4.2	-7.8	0.07	31.0	59.0
Shooting star (L1/L3)	19510	433.6	36.0	1.5	-10.5	0.06	33.0	62.0
3-bar reversal bear (L2)	405	9.0	37.0	1.5	-10.5	0.04	27.0	57.0
Pin bar bear (L2)	4504	100.1	36.0	1.3	-10.7	0.04	31.0	61.0
Doji at top (L1)	13146	292.1	35.0	1.2	-10.8	0.05	33.0	63.0
3-bar reversal bull (L2)	453	10.1	36.0	1.1	-10.9	-0.0	27.0	60.0
Engulfing bear (L2/L3)	18012	400.3	35.0	0.8	-11.2	0.05	34.0	63.0
Shrinking bear (L2)	1293	28.7	36.0	0.8	-11.2	0.08	34.0	62.0
Bear flag (L1)	208	4.6	33.0	0.7	-11.3	-0.02	31.0	65.0
Engulfing bull (L2/L3)	18127	402.8	31.0	-1.2	-13.2	-0.08	29.0	68.0
Breakout bear (L2)	182	4.0	38.0	-1.9	-13.9	0.06	27.0	54.0
Hammer (L1/L2/L3)	18248	405.5	30.0	-2.0	-14.0	-0.1	28.0	67.0
Shrinking bull (L2)	1756	39.0	31.0	-2.0	-14.0	-0.07	30.0	67.0
Doji at bottom (L1)	12032	267.4	30.0	-2.2	-14.2	-0.09	29.0	68.0
Pin bar bull (L2)	3890	86.4	31.0	-2.7	-14.7	-0.09	27.0	66.0
Bull flag (L1)	335	7.4	32.0	-3.7	-15.7	-0.05	31.0	67.0
Breakout bull (L2)	235	5.2	30.0	-9.6	-21.6	-0.13	24.0	64.0

5-min, after a 3-bar run



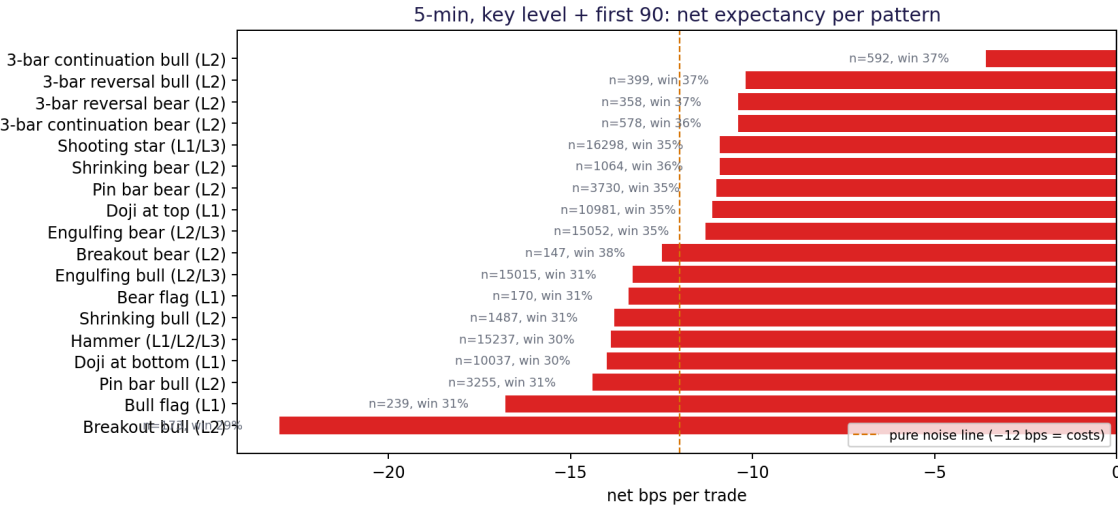
pattern	n	per_day	win%	gross_bps	net_bps	avg_R	target%	stop%
Pin bar bear (L2)	1320	29.3	35.0	1.9	-10.1	0.06	29.0	58.0
3-bar continuation bull (L2)	3198	71.1	33.0	1.5	-10.5	-0.04	26.0	61.0
Engulfing bear (L2/L3)	5721	127.1	34.0	1.0	-11.0	0.06	33.0	61.0
Shooting star (L1/L3)	5926	131.7	33.0	0.8	-11.2	0.03	30.0	61.0
Shrinking bear (L2)	4488	99.7	34.0	0.7	-11.3	0.05	32.0	61.0
Breakout bear (L2)	954	21.2	36.0	0.5	-11.5	0.04	28.0	58.0
3-bar reversal bear (L2)	2460	54.7	34.0	0.2	-11.8	0.01	25.0	56.0
3-bar continuation bear (L2)	3197	71.0	34.0	0.1	-11.9	0.01	28.0	60.0
Bear flag (L1)	1424	31.6	31.0	-0.2	-12.2	-0.05	29.0	65.0
Doji at top (L1)	4454	99.0	32.0	-0.2	-12.2	0.01	31.0	63.0
Engulfing bull (L2/L3)	7209	160.2	29.0	-1.7	-13.7	-0.12	27.0	68.0
Shrinking bull (L2)	5621	124.9	29.0	-1.8	-13.8	-0.11	28.0	68.0
Bull flag (L1)	1544	34.3	30.0	-2.1	-14.1	-0.09	28.0	66.0
Hammer (L1/L2/L3)	7606	169.0	28.0	-2.2	-14.2	-0.14	27.0	68.0
3-bar reversal bull (L2)	2707	60.2	30.0	-2.2	-14.2	-0.11	24.0	62.0
Doji at bottom (L1)	5348	118.8	28.0	-2.4	-14.4	-0.13	27.0	68.0
Pin bar bull (L2)	1664	37.0	27.0	-4.1	-16.1	-0.17	24.0	68.0
Breakout bull (L2)	975	21.7	30.0	-4.6	-16.6	-0.13	25.0	65.0

5-min, at a key level

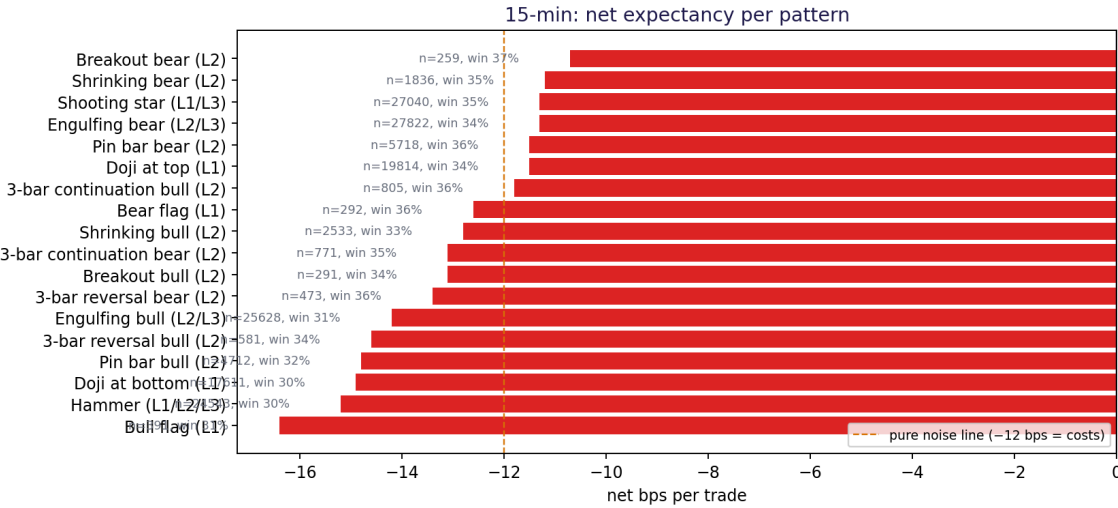


pattern	n	per_day	win%	gross_bps	net_bps	avg_R	target%	stop%
Breakout bear (L2)	694	15.4	36.0	2.8	-9.2	0.07	29.0	58.0
3-bar continuation bull (L2)	2389	53.1	34.0	2.6	-9.4	-0.02	27.0	61.0
Shrinking bear (L2)	3394	75.4	34.0	0.9	-11.1	0.06	32.0	61.0
3-bar reversal bear (L2)	1838	40.8	34.0	0.4	-11.6	0.02	26.0	56.0
Engulfing bear (L2/L3)	53059	1179.1	33.0	0.2	-11.8	0.02	32.0	64.0
Shooting star (L1/L3)	55490	1233.1	33.0	0.1	-11.9	0.0	31.0	63.0
Pin bar bear (L2)	12242	272.0	33.0	0.0	-12.0	-0.0	29.0	62.0
Doji at top (L1)	41565	923.7	32.0	-0.0	-12.0	0.0	31.0	64.0
3-bar continuation bear (L2)	2437	54.2	33.0	-0.2	-12.2	-0.0	28.0	61.0
Bear flag (L1)	1044	23.2	30.0	-0.8	-12.8	-0.05	29.0	66.0
Bull flag (L1)	1082	24.0	29.0	-1.6	-13.6	-0.09	28.0	67.0
3-bar reversal bull (L2)	2094	46.5	31.0	-1.8	-13.8	-0.1	24.0	62.0
Shrinking bull (L2)	4295	95.4	29.0	-2.0	-14.0	-0.12	27.0	68.0
Engulfing bull (L2/L3)	51532	1145.2	28.0	-2.2	-14.2	-0.14	27.0	69.0
Doji at bottom (L1)	38859	863.5	27.0	-2.9	-14.9	-0.16	26.0	69.0
Hammer (L1/L2/L3)	55301	1228.9	27.0	-3.0	-15.0	-0.17	26.0	69.0
Pin bar bull (L2)	11391	253.1	27.0	-3.6	-15.6	-0.17	24.0	68.0
Breakout bull (L2)	713	15.8	30.0	-5.4	-17.4	-0.12	25.0	65.0

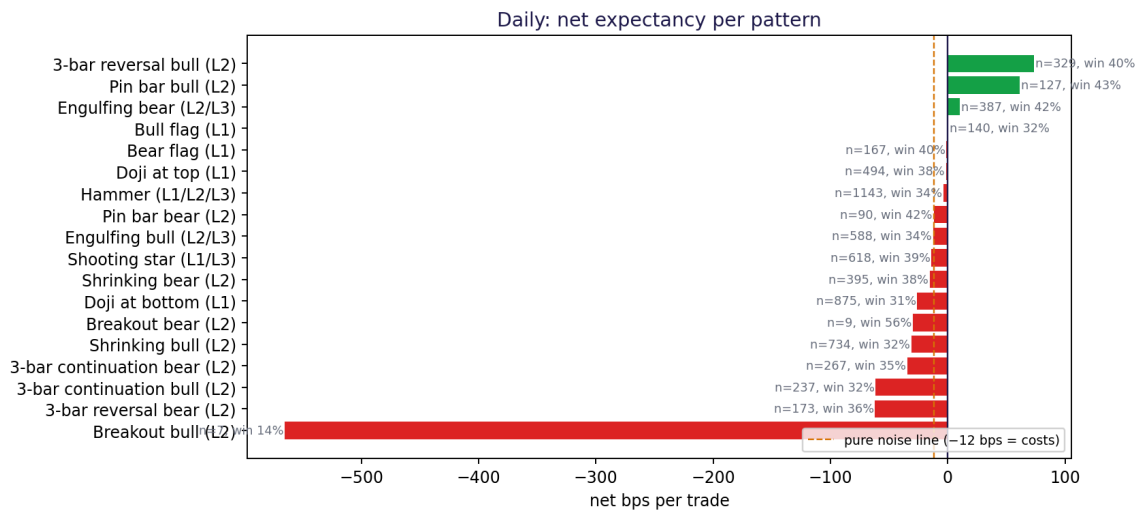
5-min, key level + first 90



pattern	n	per_day	win%	gross_bps	net_bps	avg_R	target%	stop%
3-bar continuation bull (L2)	592	13.2	37.0	8.4	-3.6	0.06	31.0	59.0
3-bar reversal bull (L2)	399	8.9	37.0	1.8	-10.2	0.01	28.0	59.0
3-bar reversal bear (L2)	358	8.0	37.0	1.6	-10.4	0.06	28.0	57.0
3-bar continuation bear (L2)	578	12.8	36.0	1.6	-10.4	0.04	30.0	60.0
Shooting star (L1/L3)	16298	362.2	35.0	1.1	-10.9	0.06	33.0	62.0
Shrinking bear (L2)	1064	23.6	36.0	1.1	-10.9	0.08	34.0	61.0
Pin bar bear (L2)	3730	82.9	35.0	1.0	-11.0	0.04	31.0	61.0
Doji at top (L1)	10981	244.0	35.0	0.9	-11.1	0.04	32.0	63.0
Engulfing bear (L2/L3)	15052	334.5	35.0	0.7	-11.3	0.05	34.0	63.0
Breakout bear (L2)	147	3.3	38.0	-0.5	-12.5	0.09	29.0	54.0
Engulfing bull (L2/L3)	15015	333.7	31.0	-1.3	-13.3	-0.08	29.0	68.0
Bear flag (L1)	170	3.8	31.0	-1.4	-13.4	-0.07	29.0	68.0
Shrinking bull (L2)	1487	33.0	31.0	-1.8	-13.8	-0.07	29.0	67.0
Hammer (L1/L2/L3)	15237	338.6	30.0	-1.9	-13.9	-0.09	28.0	67.0
Doji at bottom (L1)	10037	223.0	30.0	-2.0	-14.0	-0.09	29.0	68.0
Pin bar bull (L2)	3255	72.3	31.0	-2.4	-14.4	-0.09	28.0	66.0
Bull flag (L1)	239	5.3	31.0	-4.8	-16.8	-0.09	29.0	68.0
Breakout bull (L2)	173	3.8	29.0	-11.0	-23.0	-0.16	24.0	66.0



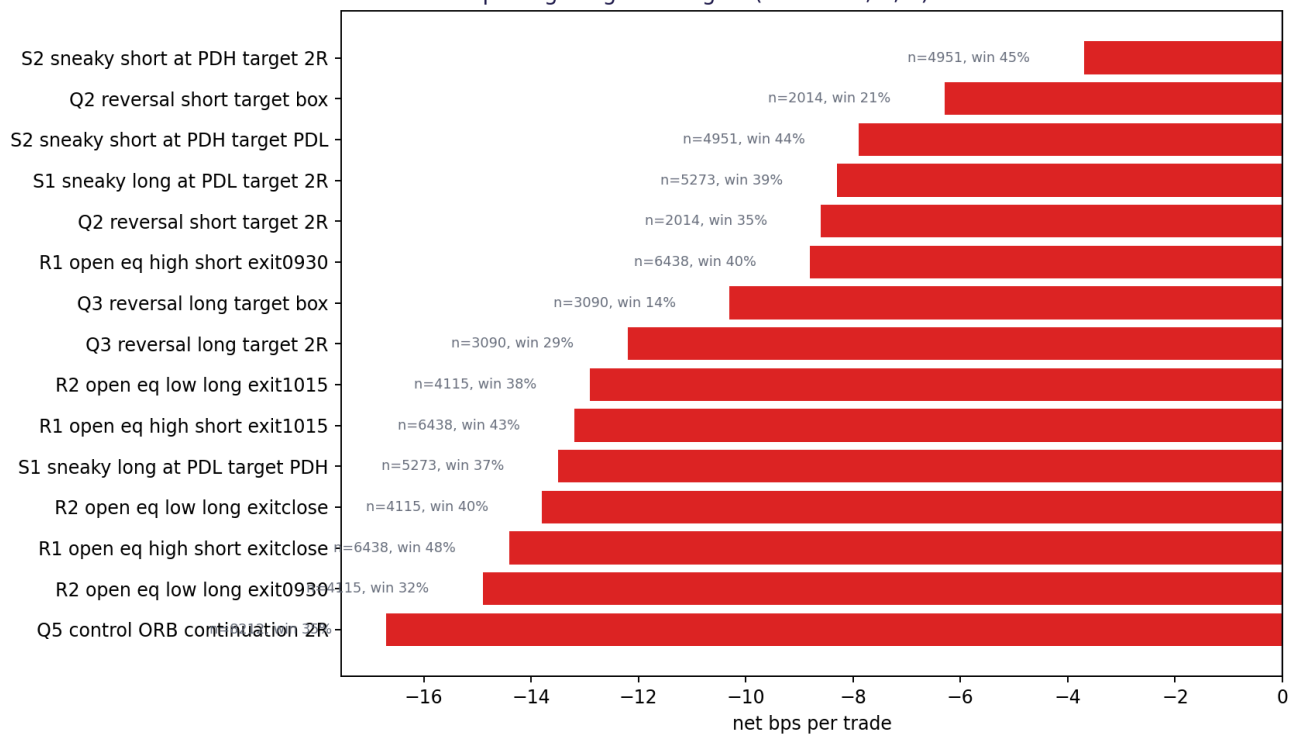
pattern	n	per_day	win%	gross_bps	net_bps	avg_R	target%	stop%
Breakout bear (L2)	259	5.8	37.0	1.3	-10.7	0.02	11.0	36.0
Shrinking bear (L2)	1836	40.8	35.0	0.8	-11.2	0.04	26.0	53.0
Shooting star (L1/L3)	27040	600.9	35.0	0.7	-11.3	0.01	24.0	53.0
Engulfing bear (L2/L3)	27822	618.3	34.0	0.7	-11.3	0.03	27.0	56.0
Pin bar bear (L2)	5718	127.1	36.0	0.5	-11.5	0.01	20.0	49.0
Doji at top (L1)	19814	440.3	34.0	0.5	-11.5	0.02	26.0	55.0
3-bar continuation bull (L2)	805	17.9	36.0	0.2	-11.8	-0.03	16.0	45.0
Bear flag (L1)	292	6.5	36.0	-0.6	-12.6	0.12	29.0	50.0
Shrinking bull (L2)	2533	56.3	33.0	-0.8	-12.8	-0.05	25.0	59.0
3-bar continuation bear (L2)	771	17.1	35.0	-1.1	-13.1	-0.02	18.0	46.0
Breakout bull (L2)	291	6.5	34.0	-1.1	-13.1	-0.05	12.0	40.0
3-bar reversal bear (L2)	473	10.5	36.0	-1.4	-13.4	0.02	14.0	35.0
Engulfing bull (L2/L3)	25628	569.5	31.0	-2.2	-14.2	-0.09	23.0	60.0
3-bar reversal bull (L2)	581	12.9	34.0	-2.6	-14.6	-0.03	13.0	39.0
Pin bar bull (L2)	4712	104.7	32.0	-2.8	-14.8	-0.09	20.0	56.0
Doji at bottom (L1)	17611	391.4	30.0	-2.9	-14.9	-0.12	23.0	61.0
Hammer (L1/L2/L3)	24543	545.4	30.0	-3.2	-15.2	-0.12	22.0	60.0
Bull flag (L1)	391	8.7	31.0	-4.4	-16.4	-0.12	19.0	58.0



pattern	n	per_day	win%	gross_bps	net_bps	avg_R	target%	stop%
3-bar reversal bull (L2)	329	1.4	40.0	85.5	73.5	0.09	19.0	40.0
Pin bar bull (L2)	127	0.5	43.0	73.4	61.4	0.08	24.0	50.0
Engulfing bear (L2/L3)	387	1.6	42.0	22.2	10.2	0.12	29.0	55.0
Bull flag (L1)	140	0.6	32.0	12.4	0.4	-0.08	25.0	61.0
Bear flag (L1)	167	0.7	40.0	11.0	-1.0	0.1	28.0	52.0
Doji at top (L1)	494	2.0	38.0	10.5	-1.5	0.04	27.0	57.0
Hammer (L1/L2/L3)	1143	4.7	34.0	8.4	-3.6	-0.07	24.0	61.0
Pin bar bear (L2)	90	0.4	42.0	-0.0	-12.0	0.02	21.0	51.0
Engulfing bull (L2/L3)	588	2.4	34.0	-0.6	-12.6	-0.08	23.0	59.0
Shooting star (L1/L3)	618	2.5	39.0	-1.9	-13.9	0.04	26.0	56.0
Shrinking bear (L2)	395	1.6	38.0	-3.3	-15.3	0.03	26.0	56.0
Doji at bottom (L1)	875	3.6	31.0	-14.0	-26.0	-0.14	23.0	65.0
Breakout bear (L2)	9	0.0	56.0	-17.7	-29.7	-0.12	0.0	44.0
Shrinking bull (L2)	734	3.0	32.0	-19.0	-31.0	-0.11	23.0	61.0
3-bar continuation bear (L2)	267	1.1	35.0	-22.4	-34.4	-0.1	16.0	54.0
3-bar continuation bull (L2)	237	1.0	32.0	-49.5	-61.5	-0.21	11.0	51.0
3-bar reversal bear (L2)	173	0.7	36.0	-50.0	-62.0	-0.05	18.0	51.0
Breakout bull (L2)	7	0.0	14.0	-553.1	-565.1	-0.83	0.0	86.0

4. The opening range: trap or truth?

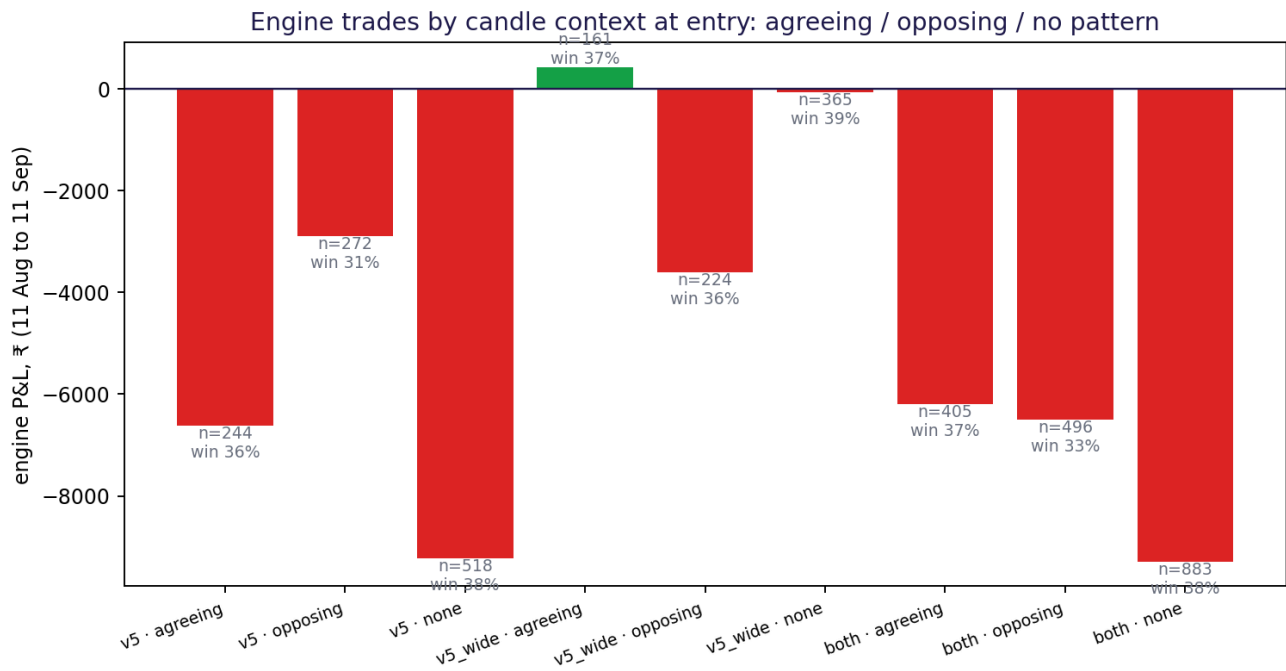
Opening-range strategies (lessons 3, 4, 5) and the ORB control



strategy	n	win / rate	net bps	avg R	target%
R2 open eq low long exit0930	4115	32%	-14.9		
R2 open eq low long exit1015	4115	38%	-12.9		
R2 open eq low long exitclose	4115	40%	-13.8		
R4 first bar colour holds to 0930	17726	49.5%			
Q1 liquidity candle rate	17720	83.3%			
Q2 reversal short target box	2014	21%	-6.3	0.27	11
Q2 reversal short target 2R	2014	35%	-8.6	0.12	36
Q5 control ORB continuation 2R	8212	35%	-16.7	-0.07	18
S2 sneaky short at PDH target PDL	4951	44%	-7.9	0.08	30
S2 sneaky short at PDH target 2R	4951	45%	-3.7	0.1	14
R1 open eq high short exit0930	6438	40%	-8.8		
R1 open eq high short exit1015	6438	43%	-13.2		
R1 open eq high short exitclose	6438	48%	-14.4		
Q3 reversal long target box	3090	14%	-10.3	0.16	9
Q3 reversal long target 2R	3090	29%	-12.2	-0.03	32
S1 sneaky long at PDL target PDH	5273	37%	-13.5	0.01	26
S1 sneaky long at PDL target 2R	5273	39%	-8.3	0.05	21

Q rows are lesson 3 (liquidity candle $\geq 25\%$ of daily ATR, then a hammer, inverted hammer or engulfing candle outside the box within 90 minutes; target the far edge of the box or 2R). Q5 is the control: ORB continuation, the bet our engines make. S rows are lesson 4 (sneaky pivot at the prior day's high or low on 15-minute bars). R rows are lesson 5 (open = high or open = low on the first 5-minute bar, exit 09:30, with longer holds as controls). R4 is the base rate that the first bar's colour holds to 09:30. Q1 is how often the opening candle qualifies as a liquidity candle.

5. What it would have done to our engines



Every closed v5 and v5_wide trade from 11 August to 11 September was tagged with the candle patterns that completed on its entry bar or the bar before. "Agreeing" means a pattern pointed the same way as the trade, "opposing" means a pattern pointed the other way, "none" means no pattern was present.

group	trades	P&L ₹	win
v5:agreeing	244	-6,624	36%
v5:opposing	272	-2,894	31%
v5:none	518	-9,220	38%
v5_wide:agreeing	161	423	37%
v5_wide:opposing	224	-3,610	36%
v5_wide:none	365	-73	39%
both:agreeing	405	-6,202	37%
both:opposing	496	-6,504	33%
both:none	883	-9,292	38%

Opposing patterns, by pattern (engine P&L of the trades they argued against)

pattern	trades	P&L ₹
Hammer (L1/L2/L3)	132	-3,266
Engulfing bear (L2/L3)	108	-1,707
Shrinking bear (L2)	12	-1,697
Doji at bottom (L1)	97	-1,501
Engulfing bull (L2/L3)	109	-1,386
Pin bar bull (L2)	19	-1,069
Shooting star (L1/L3)	89	-509
3-bar reversal bull (L2)	7	-400
Pin bar bear (L2)	14	-378
Doji at top (L1)	63	-205
3-bar continuation bull (L2)	2	-49
3-bar continuation bear (L2)	2	99
3-bar reversal bear (L2)	3	122
Breakout bull (L2)	2	793
Shrinking bull (L2)	22	797

6. Which ones work, and why

Single- and multi-candle shapes on 5-minute bars: no edge

Taking every signal all day, bullish shapes averaged **-14.6 bps** net per trade and bearish shapes **-11.9 bps**. Add back the 12 bps of costs and the gross edge is a few basis points either side of zero. The bearish side did better in every setting, but the test window (mid-July to mid-September 2026) was a falling market, so that is the regime, not the candle.

Timing helps a little, levels help a little, neither pays the costs

Restricting to the first 90 minutes lifted the bullish average to **-13.7 bps** and the bearish to **-10.8 bps**. Requiring the pattern to sit within 0.15 ATR of a key level (prior-day high, low, close or the session's running high and low) changed the average pattern by **+0.1 bps**. Combining both produced the best intraday cells (three-bar continuation and three-bar reversal in the first 90 minutes at a level), and even those stayed just below break-even after costs. Lesson 1's "only when trending" filter (a run of three same-colour bars first) did not rescue the hammer, doji or shooting star.

15-minute bars: same picture, fewer trades

Every pattern was net negative on 15-minute bars; the best was Breakout bear (L2) at **-10.7 bps**. Lesson 2's claim that patterns improve on higher timeframes is not visible at 15 minutes.

Daily bars: a few real positives, small samples

On daily bars over one year, 3-bar reversal bull (L2) (329 trades, **+74 bps**, 40% win), Pin bar bull (L2) (127 trades, **+61 bps**, 43% win), Engulfing bear (L2/L3) (387 trades, **+10 bps**, 42% win), Bull flag (L1) (140 trades, **+0 bps**, 32% win) were net positive with at least 100 trades. Daily moves are large relative to costs, so a modest edge shows through. This is the one place lesson 2's higher-timeframe claim holds, and the sample is one year of one regime, so treat it as a lead, not a result.

The opening range: neither the trap nor the truth

Lesson 5's core claim is that the first candle's colour holds for 15 minutes. On 17,726 stock-days the first 5-minute bar's colour matched the 09:15-09:30 direction **49.5%** of the time: a coin flip. Its open-equals-high short exited at 09:30 made **-8.8 bps**, and open-equals-low long **-14.9 bps**. Only one slice was positive: open-equals-low longs on the day's top-decile gappers held to the close (409 trades, **+5.7 bps**), which is the opposite of the lesson's 09:30 exit.

Lesson 3's liquidity-candle test is almost always true here: **83.3%** of opening candles exceed 25% of daily ATR (median $0.38 \times \text{ATR}$), so it does not select anything. Trading the reversal outside the box made **-6.3 bps** on the short side and **-10.3 bps** on the long side with the box-edge target; only 11% and 9% of trades reached the far edge. The control, ORB continuation (the bet our engines make),

was worse still at **-16.7 bps**. Lesson 4's sneaky pivot at the prior-day high was the best opening-range idea: **-3.7 bps** with a 45% hit rate, still short of costs.

What it would have done to the engines

Across 1,784 engine trades, those entered with an agreeing pattern lost **₹-15 per trade**, those entered against an opposing pattern lost **₹-13**, and those with no pattern lost **₹-11**. Candle context at the entry bar does not separate good engine trades from bad ones. The engines' losses come from elsewhere: the regime, the exits, and the swept-low entries documented on 11 September.

The only opposing patterns worth a veto are the ones with a large loss per trade: Shrinking bear (L2) (₹-141 per trade on 12), Pin bar bull (L2) (₹-56 per trade on 19), Pin bar bear (L2) (₹-27 per trade on 14). These are small samples and should be confirmed on more sessions before they block anything.

Why the videos and the data disagree. The teachers trade markets with a catalyst and a crowd (US small caps on news, Nasdaq at the open), use discretion to skip bad-looking setups, and remember their winners. A detector takes every instance. On a broad Indian universe with 12 bps of friction, the shape of one to four bars carries almost no information about the next 2R move. The parts of the lessons that survive are the parts that are not about shapes: trade early, trade at a level, put the stop behind structure, and confirm with the next bar. Those belong in the engine as context features, and section 6's recommendations follow from that.

Recommendations for the engines and the Floor

1. **Do not add raw candle-shape features to the scorer.** Their standalone expectancy is zero; as ML features they will fit noise.
2. **Add context features instead:** run length before the bar, distance to prior-day high/low/close and to the session high/low in ATR units, minutes since the open, and the opening-range position (inside, above, below the 09:15-09:30 box). These are the only things that moved expectancy in the right direction in this test.
3. **Use the opposing-pattern tag as a veto, not the agreeing tag as an entry.** Section 5 shows which opposing patterns coincided with engine losses. That is the same lesson as the swept-low reclaim finding from 11 September: the cheapest improvement is to stop the worst entries, not to add new ones.
4. **Feed the Floor the same context.** Its SWEEP_RECLAIM is the reclaim family here; point it at the engine universe and it becomes the live detector for the veto.